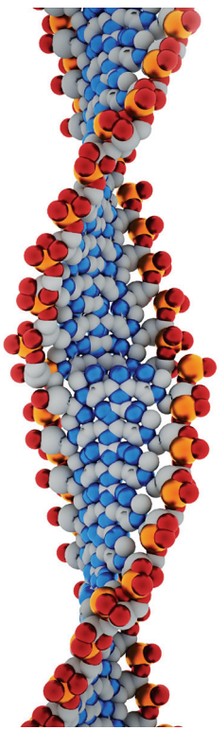
Unit 7 NUCLEIC ACIDS



The Swiss scientist Friedrich Miescher who discovered DNA in 1869 and also suggested that they may play a role in heredity.



Learning objectives

After studying this unit the students will be able to

- Explain the role played by nucleic acids in an organism
- Relate DNA with inheritance of traits from ancestors
- Describe the structural differences between bases, nucleosides and nucleotides.
- Explain the Chargaff's rule
- Elaborate the structure of DNA and RNA
- Differentiate the DNA from RNA

Introduction

We might have heard people saying, "It is in your genes?", "like mother, like daughter". Many physical traits like skin colour, curly or straight hair etc... are inherited from our parents or grandparents. We also inherit talent in special fields such as art, music, etc from then. How are these characters inherited? This is through the agents of inheritance called DNA.

Nucleic acids were first discovered by Friedrich Miescher in 1869 and were named as nuclein as they were found

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